

Merchant Onboarding Process Map

Level 1 end-to-end map, Level 2 drill-down and policy traceability for NorthPay — a UK B2B payments company.

SAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Purpose & how to read this pack

Who this documentation is for, and what each level of the map shows.

Why this documentation exists

- **Leadership visibility.** A single, current picture of how merchant onboarding actually runs — who owns what, where the hand-offs are, and where the decision points sit — without needing to ask three teams for three different answers.
- **Policy-to-process traceability.** Every step is linked to the internal policies that govern it (Section 03). When a policy changes, the affected steps are immediately identifiable; when a process changes, the policies that may need review are equally visible.
- **Faster onboarding of new joiners.** As a side benefit, the map and its drill-downs double as orientation material — a new analyst can see where their work sits in the whole within their first hour.

Levels of the map

Level 1 (Section 01) shows the end-to-end process: nine steps from merchant application to go-live, with the two formal decision gates and their exception paths. It is deliberately readable in under two minutes.

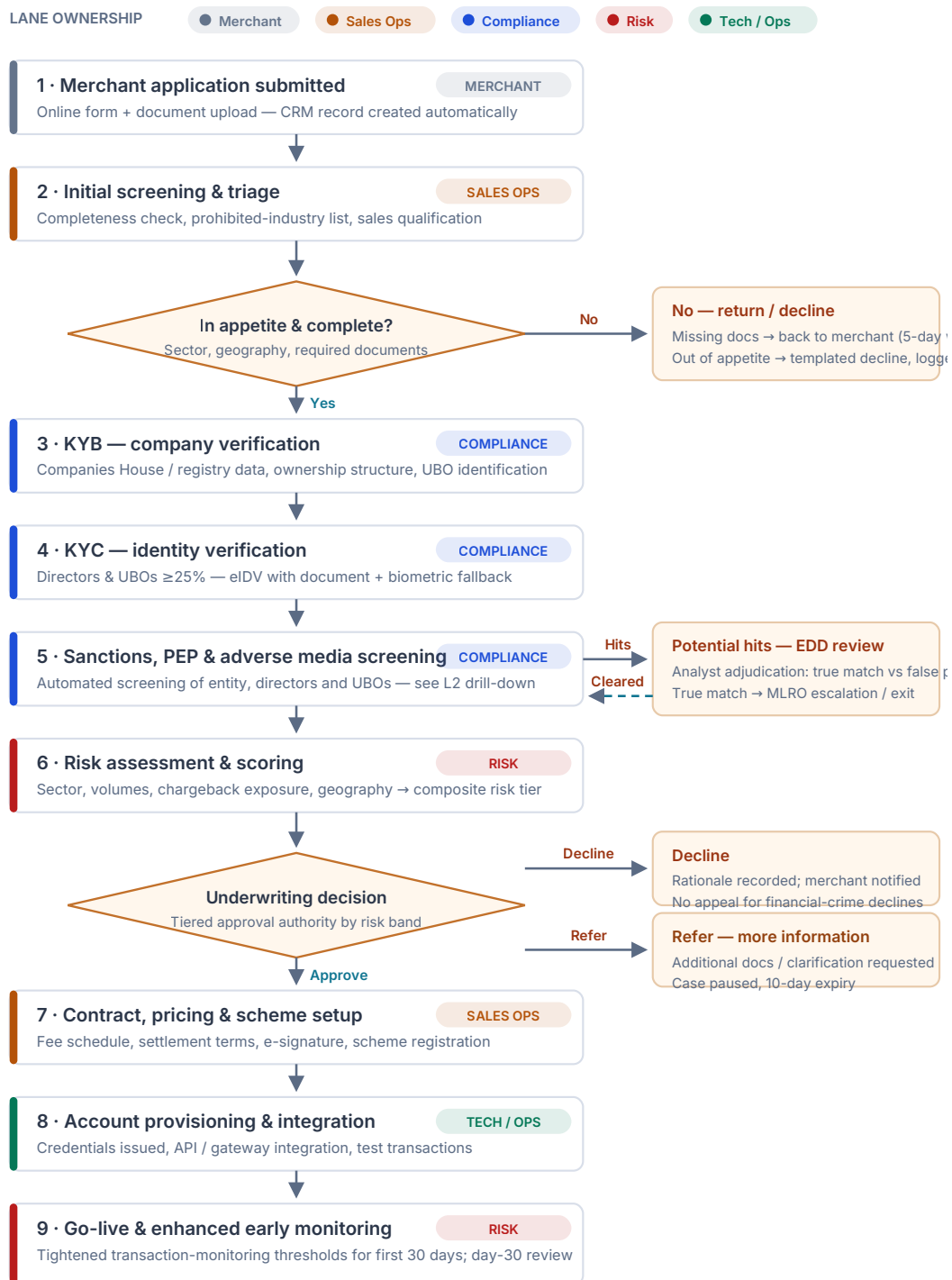
Level 2 drill-downs expand a single L1 step into its working detail — sub-steps, queues and micro-decisions. This pack includes one worked drill-down (Step 5 — screening) as an illustration; in a live engagement, every step that warrants it receives its own L2 map. Steps are numbered so the hierarchy is unambiguous: step 5 at Level 1, 5.1–5.5 at Level 2.

In a live engagement the content is built from structured interviews with the people who own each step — typically two to three 45-minute sessions — and validated against the systems actually in use. A companion SOP pack documents the operating procedure for each step; map and SOPs are kept as separate artefacts because they serve different readers.

A note on scope. This documentation describes and maps operational process. It is not legal or regulatory advice, and it does not constitute an opinion on compliance with any regulatory regime. NorthPay is a fictional company; this pack is a worked sample showing the standard of documentation DL Consulting delivers.

Level 1 — end-to-end process map

Merchant application through go-live. Coloured markers show the owning team; amber shapes are decision points and exception paths. Target cycle: 5–8 working days for a standard-risk merchant.



Reading this map. The central spine is the happy path. Amber diamonds are the two formal decision gates; amber side boxes are exception paths, each with a defined owner and time window. Steps 3–5 are hard gates enforced in workflow: no case reaches risk scoring without completed KYB, KYC and screening. Step 5 carries a Level 2 drill-down — see Section 02.

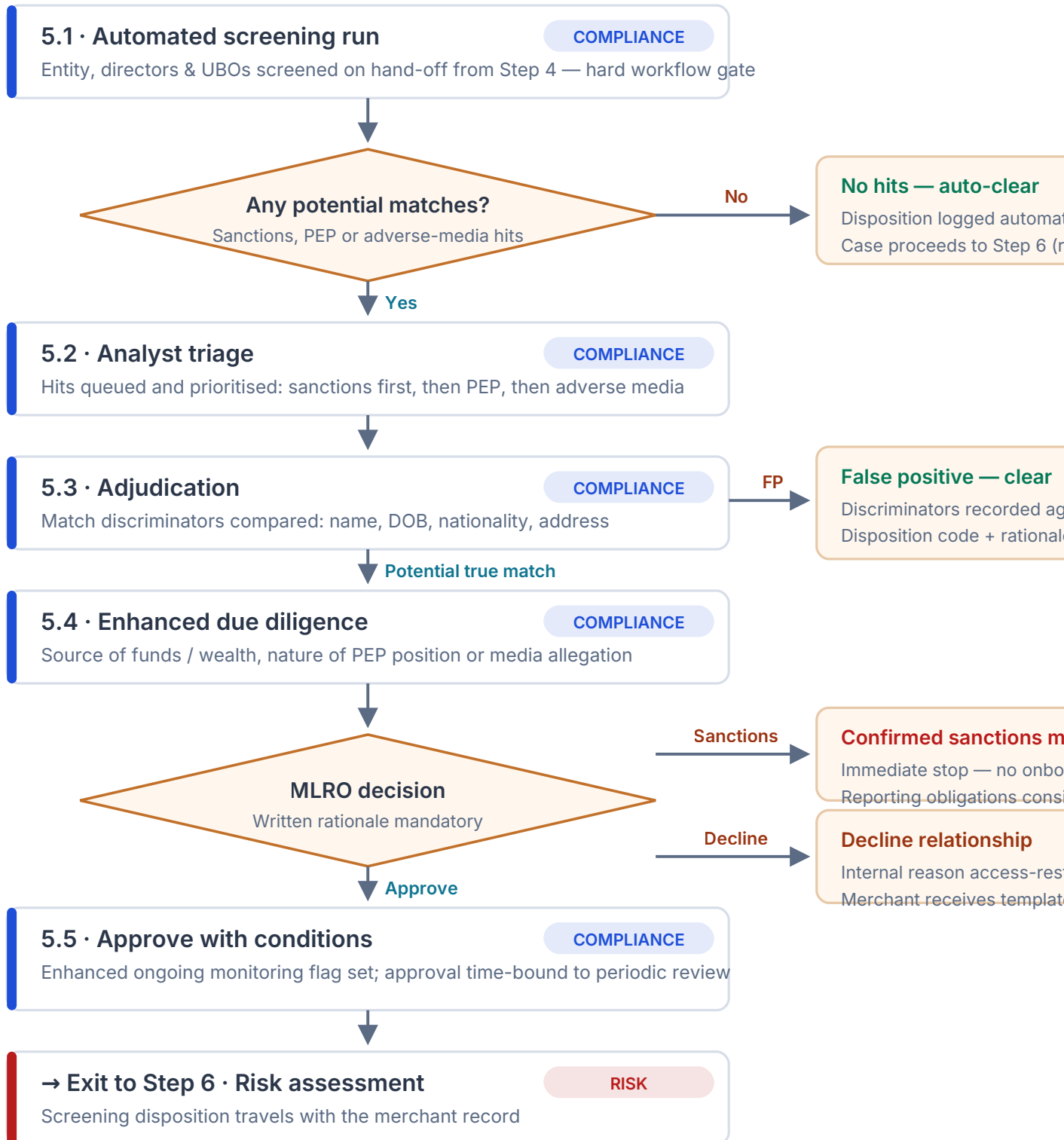
Level 2 drill-down — Step 5: screening

One Level 1 step expanded into its working detail. This is the level at which queues, adjudication logic and escalation routes become visible — and the level a new team member actually works at.

STEP 5 — LEVEL 2

● Compliance

● Risk



Policy traceability

Each process step is linked to the internal policies that govern it. This matrix is the bridge that keeps documentation and governance in sync — in both directions.

Step	Process step	Linked internal policies
1–2	Application & triage	Merchant Acceptance & Risk Appetite Policy · Prohibited Industries List · Data Protection Policy
3	KYB — company verification	AML & CTF Policy · Customer Due Diligence Standard · Records Retention Policy
4	KYC — identity verification	Customer Due Diligence Standard · Outsourcing & Third-Party Policy (eIDV vendor) · Data Protection Policy
5	Screening & EDD	Sanctions Policy · AML & CTF Policy · PEP & Enhanced Due Diligence Standard
6–7	Risk assessment & underwriting	Merchant Acceptance & Risk Appetite Policy · Underwriting Authority Matrix · Reserves & Settlement Policy
8	Contract & provisioning	Pricing & Settlement Policy · Information Security Policy · Scheme Compliance Standards
9	Go-live & early monitoring	Transaction Monitoring Standard · AML & CTF Policy

How the traceability works in practice

- **Policy changes → process review.** When a policy owner updates a policy, this matrix identifies exactly which steps (and which SOPs in the companion pack) must be reviewed. The review is recorded in the document control log, so the map never silently drifts out of date.
- **Process changes → policy review.** When a team changes how a step operates — a new tool, a new threshold, a reassigned owner — the linked policies are checked for consistency before the change is adopted. If the change conflicts with policy, either the change or the policy is amended; it is never left ambiguous.
- **One owner per link.** Each policy in the matrix has a named owner; each process step has a named owner. Keeping both names against the link is what makes the mechanism actually fire, rather than remaining a nice diagram.

Policy names above are illustrative for NorthPay; in a live engagement the matrix is built against the client's actual policy register.

About DL Consulting

DL Consulting documents critical processes for fintech and payments companies: end-to-end process maps with drill-downs, operational SOPs, and policy-to-process traceability — so leadership can see how the business actually runs, new joiners ramp faster, and a change to any policy or process is never a surprise to the other. The standard engagement — the **Process Sprint** — covers three critical processes in two weeks, built from short structured interviews with your team and delivered in your tools (Notion, Confluence or PDF).

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